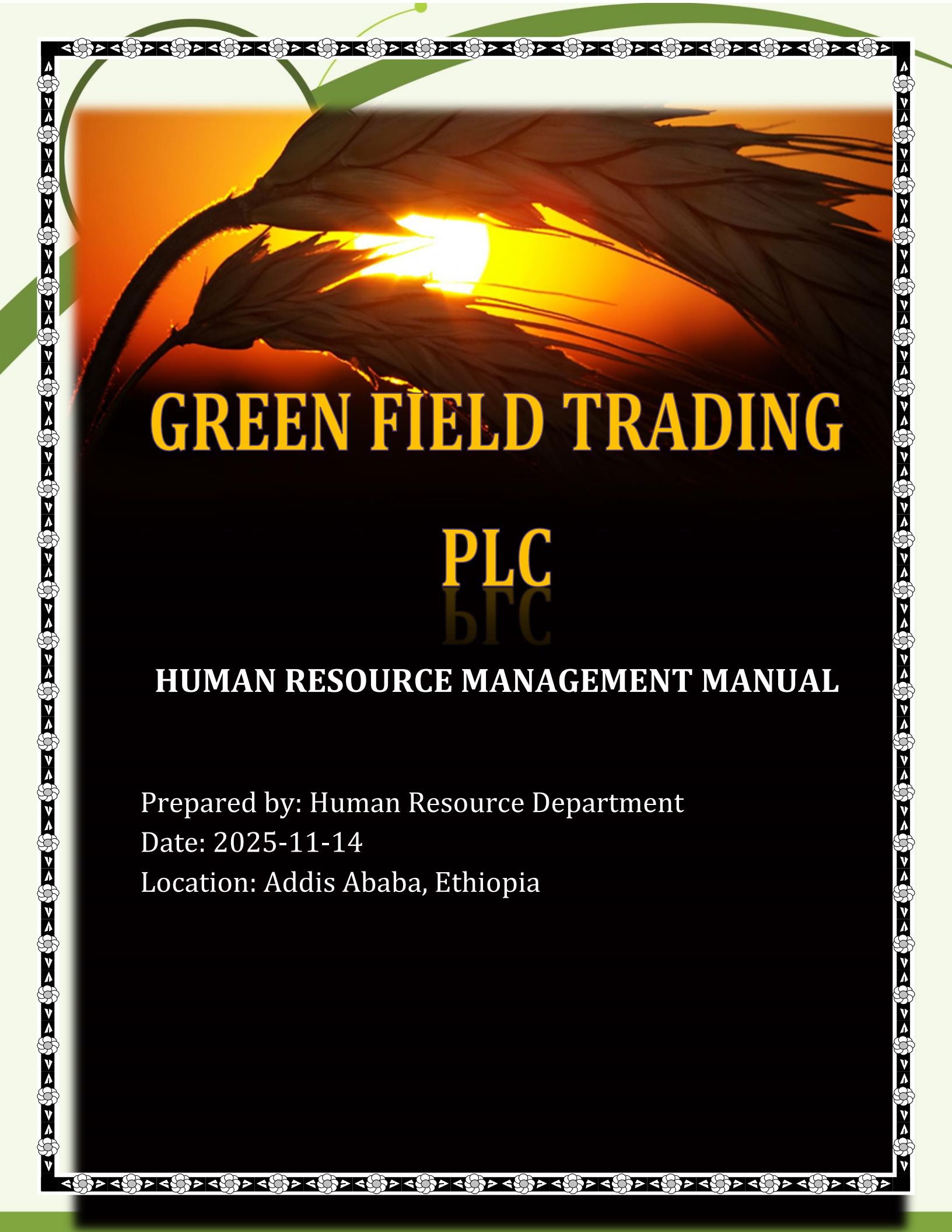




GREEN FIELD TRADING

PLC
BTC

HUMAN RESOURCE MANAGEMENT MANUAL

Prepared by: Human Resource Department

Date: 2025-11-14

Location: Addis Ababa, Ethiopia

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LIST OF ABBREVIATIONS

- **Abbreviation Full Form -Description**
- AORR-Annual Organizational Review Report
- ATA-Agricultural Transformation Agency

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- CAPA-Corrective and Preventive Action
- CCCA-Cooperative Community Group
- CSR-Corporate Social Responsibility
- ECAE-Ethiopian Conformity Assessment Enterprise
- FAO-Food and Agriculture Organization of the United Nations
- FDR- Federal Democratic Republic of Ethiopia
- HR-Human Resources
- HRD-Human Resource Development
- HRIS-Human Resource Information System
- HRIAP-Human Resource Improvement Action Plan
- HRM-Human Resource Management
- IDP-Individual Development Plan
- ILO-International Labour Organization
- ISO-International Organization for Standardization
- IT-Information Technology
- KPI-Key Performance Indicator
- M&E-Monitoring and Evaluation
- MR-CAN-Microbial Regenerative Compost Nutrient Activator
- NDAs-Non-Disclosure Agreements
- NPKCS-Nitrogen-Phosphorus-Potassium-Carbon-Sulphurratio (fertilizer nutrient ratio)
- OHS-Occupational Health and Safety
- OPM-Organic Production and Marketing Project
- PIP-Performance Improvement Plan
- PIL-Performance Improvement Log
- PSC-Project Steering Committee
- PMS - Performance Management System
- R&T- Research and Training Center
- ROI-Return on Investment
- SME-Small and Medium Enterprise
- ToT--Training of Trainers
- UNDP- United Nations Development Programme
- WHO-World Health Organization



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1.1 Background

The Greenfield Trading PLC - Organic Production and Marketing (OPM) Project is a large-scale, 2,000-hectare integrated organic farming investment located in Abobo Woreda, Anywa Zone, Gambella Region. Its purpose is to revolutionize organic farming through the application of Moisture-Retaining and Composite Nutrient-Availing (MR-CNA) soil technology, an Ethiopian-designed biotechnological soil amendment formulated from local organic resources (plant foliage, manure, ash, and mineral-rich soil mixtures).

Within this framework, Human Resource Management (HRM) is not merely administrative but a strategic production input. The HR function ensures that the project's human capital aligns with technical, financial, and social objectives, particularly in:

Deploying experts in organic agronomy, MR-CNA soil microbiology, and land-husbandry, Coordinating Common Commodity Groups (CCGs) composed of youth entrepreneurs producing MR-CNA soil composites, and Managing multidisciplinary teams across three geographic tiers - Addis Ababa Headquarters, Gambella Regional Office, and Abobo Farm Site. According to Dr. Azene's project proposal, the human-capital plan emphasizes youth employment, gender inclusion, and technical excellence. A total of six crop-based departments (spice, fruit, timber, etc.) require specialized manpower, complemented by administrative and logistical teams.

Therefore, this HR Manual's first chapter situates the workforce within Greenfield Trading PLC's broader institutional and socio-economic vision: to link modern organic agribusiness with environmental restoration, export competitiveness, and community empowerment.

1.2 Purpose of the HR Manual

The HR Manual provides a policy framework and governance mechanism for every personnel-related function across the OPM Project. Its principal purposes are:

1. Standardization of HR Practices: Creating a uniform recruitment, training, 100% and evaluation system across HQ, regional, and field offices.

2. Transparency and Accountability: Aligning all HR operations with the Government of Ethiopia's labour proclamations (Labour Proclamation No. 1156/2019) and the reporting standards of international donors (e.g., World Bank and AfDB Guidelines on Project Personnel Management).

3. Integration with Operational Planning: Embedding HRM processes into the Annual Work Plan and Budget (AWPB) and the eight-year project-phase plan (2026-2033) to ensure timely availability of qualified staff.

4. Capacity Building and Knowledge Transfer: Supporting continuous professional development in organic agronomy, MR-CNA manufacturing, and land-husbandry engineering, consistent with the capacity-building objectives stated in the OPM project's facilitation component.

Thus, the HR Manual functions as both a policy guide and a management tool, enabling consistency between human-resource planning and the scientific-technical design of the project.

1.3 Scope

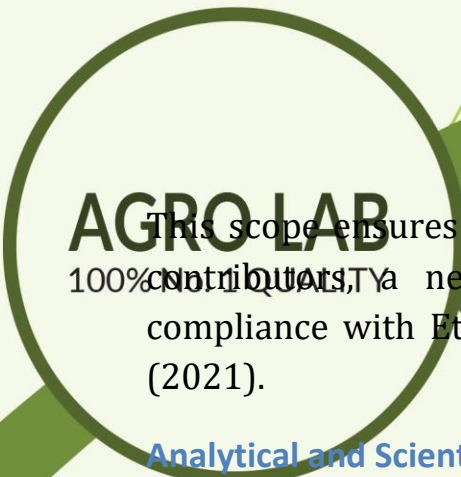
The HR policies apply to all categories of employees and partners involved in OPM operations:

Headquarters (Addis Ababa): Strategic leadership, finance, and project-wide coordination.

Regional Office (Gambella): Program implementation management, training, and liaison with government agencies.

Farm Site (Abobo): Direct supervision of production, logistics, and quality control in the 2000-ha pilot area.

CCGs and Contractors: Organized youth groups and community-based enterprises tasked with MR-CNA preparation, transport, and application.



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This scope ensures inclusive coverage of both formal staff and contractual contributors, a necessary condition for accountability to donors and compliance with Ethiopia's Federal Public-Private Partnership Framework (2021).

Analytical and Scientific Note

From a management-science perspective, Chapter I establishes the organizational ecology of the OPM project. The 2,000-ha farm operates as a complex adaptive system where biophysical and human inputs interact. The MR-CNA soil technology depends on trained technical operators and microbiological quality control, necessitating structured HR systems for:

Competency-based recruitment (soil scientists, agronomists, extension officers),

Continuous in-service training (learning while producing model introduced in Chapter VI), and

Performance-linked reward mechanisms to foster innovation and productivity.

The chapter therefore grounds HRM in both organizational behavior theory and applied agronomic science, recognizing that human knowledge and motivation are the catalysts transforming organic resources into measurable outputs (e.g., 38,000 tons of MR-CNA per year, export-grade organic produce).

CHAPTER II: ORGANIZATIONAL STRUCTURE

2.1 Governance Framework

The governance framework of the Organic Production and Marketing (OPM) Project is designed as a multi-tiered management system linking national, regional, and operational structures under Greenfield Trading PLC.

At the top is the Project Steering Committee (PSC), which serves as the policy-making and oversight body. The PSC ensures that OPM's objectives remain consistent with Ethiopia's Strategic Plan for Agricultural Transformation (SPAT 2004) and donor accountability standards (World Bank & AfDB project governance norms).

Below the PSC, the Project Director holds executive authority - supervising the overall strategy, coordination, and financial integrity of the project. This includes responsibility for resource mobilization, donor liaison, and implementation of the Annual Work Plan and Budget (AWPB).

The Lead Technical Advisor (LTA) is the project's scientific head, responsible for guiding innovations in MR-CNA soil biotechnology, agronomy, and organic value-chain management. This position bridges the science-policy interface by ensuring that every production phase - from soil composting to marketing - adheres to scientific standards and sustainability indicators.

The Regional Project Manager (Gambella Office) handles implementation oversight, translating the directives of HQ into field-level execution. The Farm Manager supervises on-site operations such as MR-CNA production, logistics, and crop management.

This structure mirrors the decentralized governance model recommended in modern agricultural development frameworks (FAO, 2022), enabling decision-making autonomy while maintaining centralized accountability.



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2.2 Departmental Structure

100% Greenfield Trading PLC's OPM project has eight interdependent departments designed to integrate science, production, and administration for an efficient organic agribusiness ecosystem.

1. Project Management & Coordination

Coordinates all departments, oversees implementation, manages donor reporting, and ensures the strategic execution of the eight-year plan (2026-2033).

2. Land-Husbandry & Agronomy

Implements improved soil management, land-leveling, and crop rotation. This department also coordinates CCGs that apply MR-CNA across 2,000 hectares.

3. MR-CNA Production & Quality Control

Core scientific department responsible for manufacturing 38,000 tons of MR-CNA soil composite per year, conducting microbiological analysis, nutrient balancing, and ensuring product compliance with ECAE and international organic standards (ISO 17025).

4. Marketing, Value Addition & Export

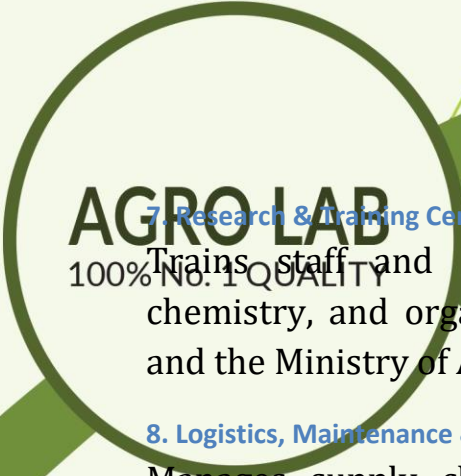
Handles post-harvest processing, grading, and packaging of organic products (spices, fruits, timber). It also develops export linkages to Europe and Middle East markets, as identified in the proposal's marketing section.

5. Monitoring, Evaluation & Reporting (M&E)

Monitors performance indicators - including productivity, soil fertility, and social inclusion - and provides data for midterm and final project evaluations.

6. Finance & Administration

Prepares budgets, manages donor funds, ensures adherence to Ethiopian accounting standards, and handles salary disbursement and procurement oversight (consistent with donor requirements under QCBS and LCS selection models).



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7. Research & Training Center (R&T)

Trains staff and local youth in MR-CNA soil microbiology, compost chemistry, and organic farming techniques. Collaborates with universities and the Ministry of Agriculture on applied research.

8. Logistics, Maintenance & Security

Manages supply chains for MR-CNA inputs, oversees farm machinery, transportation, and on-site safety.

Inter-departmental synergy ensures that each functional unit contributes to the project's long

term sustainability - from soil preparation to export-market readiness.

2.3 Staff Categories

The HRM manual categorizes staff into four tiers, reflecting a hierarchical yet competency-based structure:

This four-tier structure ensures clear reporting lines and supports both vertical accountability (policy to field) and horizontal collaboration (departments to departments).

Each role will later have a detailed Job Description (JD) (see Chapter V), including KPIs and required qualifications aligned with the Ethiopian labour framework and the International Labour Organization's competency-based HR standards.

Integrated HR-Project Linkage

The HR structure is deliberately synchronized with the institutional arrangements described in Dr. Azene's Final Project Proposal:

The Addis Ababa HQ (Project Management & Technical Advisory)

The Regional Gambella Office (Implementation Coordination)

The Farm Gate Office (Production Supervision)

Together, they form a three-tier networked system for managing human and technical resources.



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This model supports:

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Scalable delegation of authority,

Efficient communication flows, and Real-time field feedback for adaptive management.

Such integration aligns with Ethiopia's Rural Job Creation Strategy (2020-2025), which promotes decentralized agricultural entrepreneurship and youth empowerment.

Scientific and Management Commentary

From a systems-design perspective, this organizational structure adopts principles of integrated value chain governance (Porter, 1985; FAO, 2018), where the project acts as both a producer and an incubator of innovation.

The MR-CNA Production Department represents the “knowledge and innovation hub.”

The Research & Training Center represents knowledge diffusion and capacity building.

The Marketing Department ensures value capture and export competitiveness.

The HR structure, therefore, is biologically inspired - decentralized yet interconnected, mirroring how soil microbiota sustain an ecosystem. Each department functions as a “cell” in the organizational organism of Greenfield's OPM system.

CHAPTER III: HUMAN RESOURCE PLANNING

3.1 Workforce Forecasting

The OPM Project's human resource planning is built around its eight-year phased implementation plan (2026-2033). The workforce strategy reflects both the scientific intensity of the MR-CNA technology and the agro-industrial scale of operations across 2,000 hectares.

1. Planning Framework

The HR demand is projected using a 3:1 ratio of field-to-headquarters personnel, consistent with the project's focus on on-site organic production and MR-CNA soil preparation.

This ensures that most human resources are allocated where value is physically created - in the fields of Gambella and Abobo - while maintaining strategic and administrative efficiency in Addis Ababa.

The project phases require a dynamic HR forecast:

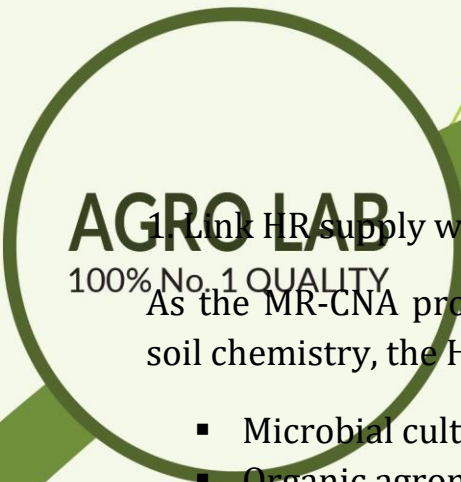
Each project stage triggers different HR priorities: from construction-type operations (land-husbandry and MR-CNA manufacturing) to knowledge-based production and export management.

This adaptive HR planning model is aligned with international standards for agricultural project staffing cycles (FAO, 2019), emphasizing temporal flexibility and human capital optimization.

3.2 Manpower Development Plan

The manpower development plan serves as a mechanism for continual learning, upskilling, and knowledge transfer. It integrates annual HR reviews with the Annual Work Plan and Budget (AWPB).

Key Objectives:



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1. Link HR supply with technological demand:

As the MR-CNA process combines microbiological engineering and organic soil chemistry, the HR plan identifies technical experts in:

- Microbial culture and soil bio-reactor management,
- Organic agronomy and compost technology,
- Quality control and nutrient analysis.

2. Promote sustainable employment:

Seasonal and contractual workers are recruited through Common Commodity Groups (CCGs) - community-based cooperatives of trained youth - ensuring social inclusion while supporting scalable labour mobilization.

3. Integrate HR Planning with Capacity Development:

Each year's manpower review updates departmental staffing needs, identifies training gaps, and adjusts human resource forecasts according to:

- Crop cycles and MR-CNA production targets,
- Farm mechanization requirements,
- New export-market demands for organic produce.

4. Career Path and Succession Planning:

Senior management positions (Department Heads, Regional Managers) include succession pipelines, ensuring knowledge continuity in long-term project phases.

3.3 Gender and Inclusion Policy

The Gender and Inclusion Policy ensures that HR planning reflects both social justice and operational efficiency.

Policy Commitments:

1. Minimum 40% female employment in CCGs and administrative support roles.

This aligns with Ethiopia's National Gender Policy (2021) and the African Union's Agenda 2063 Goal 17, promoting women's economic empowerment in agribusiness.

2. Youth and local community prioritization:

The project prioritizes recruitment from Gambella's local youth population, particularly high-school graduates seeking employment in MR-CNA production and land-husbandry.

Each CCG (Common Commodity Group) recruits, trains, and employs local members under contract with the OPM Project Office.

3. Cultural inclusion:

OPM recognizes Gambella's ethnic diversity (Anuak, Nuer, Majang, and others) and integrates intercultural training for supervisors to foster collaboration and minimize workplace bias.

4. Equal Pay for Equal Work:

Compensation systems are designed based on skill level and job classification (see Chapter VIII), ensuring pay equity regardless of gender or regional origin.

5. Safe and Supportive Work Environment:

The HR department mandates gender-sensitive facilities (sanitation, rest areas, and housing) and provides anti-harassment training and a confidential grievance redress mechanism (linked to Chapter IX).

Developmental Rationale:

This policy embodies the "inclusive green economy" principle - combining environmental sustainability (organic farming) with social inclusiveness (youth and women's employment).

By empowering local communities, Greenfield Trading PLC ensures ownership, continuity, and reduced turnover-factors critical for sustainable agricultural success in rural Ethiopia.

Scientific and Management Interpretation



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From a management-science viewpoint, Human Resource Planning in the 100% OPM1 Project represents a biological growth model - mirroring how ecosystems adapt over time.

Just as soil biota evolve to maintain balance, OPM's HR planning is structured for adaptive capacity: adjusting to environmental, technological, and market shifts.

Key Strategic Dimensions:

Systemic Integration: HR planning is embedded within project budgeting, ensuring human capital cost is forecasted alongside inputs like MR-CNA raw materials and machinery.

Cognitive Capital Development: Through continuous training, OPM invests in intellectual capital that underpins innovation - transforming traditional agriculture into a knowledge-based organic enterprise.

Socio-Ecological Alignment: Recruitment strategies emphasize hiring individuals from local ecosystems - those who understand soil, water, and plant interactions - making them integral to sustainable land stewardship.

This integrative model reflects current global paradigms of "bio-human synchronization" in agricultural projects (UNDP, 2023), where human development parallels ecological restoration.

PART IV: RECRUITMENT AND SELECTION POLICY

4.1 Recruitment Principles (Expanded)

The recruitment system of Greenfield Trading PLC - Organic Production and Marketing (OPM) Project - is designed as a human capital acquisition and alignment mechanism. Its primary aim is to attract, assess, and retain individuals whose competencies advance both the scientific objectives (MR-CNA soil biotechnology) and social mandates (community employment and gender inclusion) of the project.

Guiding Principles:

1. Meritocracy and Competence-Based Selection:

Recruitment decisions are grounded in a candidate's technical qualifications, experience, and demonstrated competency. This applies strongly to positions related to:

- MR-CNA production engineering
- Soil microbiology
- Organic agronomy

Environmental safety and sustainability Merit-based selection promotes organizational excellence and aligns human capacity with project performance indicators such as yield per hectare and compost quality control.

2. Transparency and Fairness:

The recruitment process adheres to Ethiopian Labour Law and international donor compliance frameworks (World Bank, IFAD, FAO). Every vacancy must be publicly communicated through:

Digital platforms (e.g., MoA website, regional job boards)

Local community meetings in Gambella and Abobo

Notice boards at CCG centers

This transparency fosters stakeholder trust and deters corruption or nepotism.

3. Equal Opportunity and Inclusion:

In line with the National Gender Policy (2021) and OPM's inclusion framework, the recruitment policy guarantees:

40% female representation in the workforce (with emphasis on CCGs and administrative roles)

Youth participation (18-35 years)

Local hiring priority for community members of Abobo and Gambella, enhancing ownership and retention.

4. Community Partnership Recruitment (CCG Integration):

Recruitment of field workers and technical assistants occurs through Common Commodity Groups (CCGs) - cooperative units that blend employment with local entrepreneurship.

Each CCG:

- Signs a performance-based contract with OPM;
- Receives MR-CNA training from the Research & Training Center;
- Supplies labour for soil composting, field spreading, and post-harvest handling;
- Gains income-sharing based on productivity (tons of MR-CNA or hectares maintained).

5. Ethical and Sustainable Recruitment:

The policy bans child labour, discrimination, and any form of exploitative engagement. It promotes an environmentally conscious workforce by incorporating sustainability questions in the interview process to assess the applicant's ecological awareness.

100% Recruitment follows a structured and auditable workflow that integrates technical validation, financial authorization, and compliance verification.

Below is the detailed procedure with operational logic:

Internal vs. External Recruitment:

Internal Recruitment:

Promotions and transfers are encouraged for existing staff who demonstrate outstanding performance (see Chapter VII). This supports motivation and knowledge retention.

External Recruitment:

Used when specialized expertise (e.g., MR-CNA microbial analysis, export logistics) is unavailable internally. OPM partners with universities, agricultural colleges, and technical institutes to identify candidates.

Selection Methods:

1. Document Screening - Educational background and certifications.
2. Technical Tests - For scientific roles (soil chemist, MR-CNA engineer).
3. Behavioral Interviews - Assess leadership, teamwork, and adaptability.
4. Group Assessments - For CCG-based recruitments, evaluating cooperative skills.
5. Medical and Background Checks - To ensure physical fitness for fieldwork and verify credentials.

All results are evaluated quantitatively using a 100-point scoring matrix, assigning:

- 40 points for technical knowledge,
- 30 points for experience,
- 20 points for behavioral fit,

16 points for local and gender preference.

Candidates scoring above 70% proceed to contract negotiation.

4.3 Probation and Confirmation (Expanded)

The probation policy aims to ensure performance validation before permanent employment.

Duration: Three months (extendable to six under special cases).

Evaluation: Based on monthly performance review reports by direct supervisors and HR checklists.

Criteria:

- *Technical efficiency (output quality and timeliness),*
- *Attendance and discipline,*
- *Team cooperation,*
- *Safety and compliance with MR-CNA standards.*
- *After satisfactory evaluation:*

The HR Department issues a Confirmation Letter signed by the Project Director.

Unsatisfactory employees may be given one-month remedial training before termination.

Probation also functions as a knowledge integration period where new recruits learn about MR-CNA technology, Greenfield's environmental ethics, and operational safety standards.

4.4 Talent Pool and Succession Planning

To reduce delays and costs in recruitment, the HR Department maintains a Talent Pool Database within the HRIS. It includes:

- Pre-screened candidates,
- CCG trainees who completed MR-CNA certification,
- Former employees eligible for rehire.

Succession planning ensures continuity for key positions (e.g., Project Director, Department Heads) by identifying internal staff for future leadership training. This aligns with ILO's (2018) Human Capital Continuity Framework for agricultural institutions.

4.5 Linkage to Performance and Capacity Building

Recruitment is strategically linked to training (Chapter VI) and performance appraisal (Chapter VII).

For instance:

The R&T Center provides technical screening and later conducts capacity building for recruits.

HR decisions about promotions or contract renewals are tied to performance KPIs defined in Chapter V.

This integration turns recruitment into a continuous human capital cycle- from hiring, training, evaluating, and developing.

Scientific and Management Commentary

Recruitment in the OPM project follows the logic of biological system optimization - analogous to ecosystem succession, where suitable species (skills) occupy ecological niches (roles) to stabilize the system (organization).

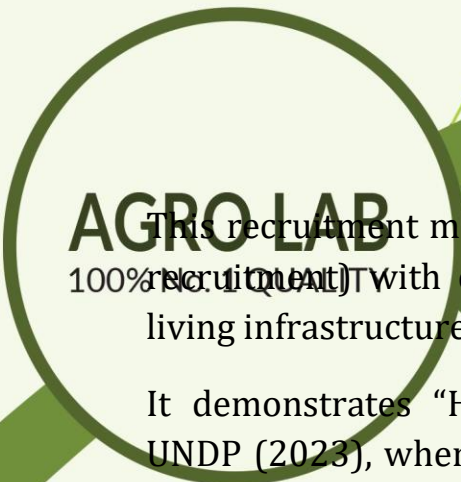
Scientific Dimensions:

Each recruit functions as a bio-technical input, contributing intellectual and manual energy to the MR-CNA soil ecosystem.

Diversity (gender, culture, discipline) enhances “organizational biodiversity,” increasing resilience and innovation capacity.

Ethical recruitment protects both organizational health and ecological ethics - aligning human systems with soil-life conservation.

Management Insight:



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This recruitment model integrates modern HRM theory (competency-based recruitment) with ecological economics, emphasizing that people are the living infrastructure of sustainable production.

It demonstrates “Human-Biosphere Integration”, a concept drawn from UNDP (2023), where environmental stewardship and employment strategy coevolve.

PART V: JOB CLASSIFICATION AND DESCRIPTION

5.1 Job Grades and Organizational Hierarchy

Job classification at Greenfield Trading PLC (OPM Project) serves as a structural mechanism to define authority, responsibility, and accountability throughout the organization.

It ensures fair pay, transparent promotion pathways, and alignment between human capital capacity and the technical complexity of MR-CNA-based organic production.

Grading Structure Overview

This classification ensures a logical chain of command, minimizing overlap and ensuring that each position has a measurable output connected to project goals such as soil fertility improvement, MR-CNA tonnage, and export performance.

Scientific Rationale

In MR-CNA production, the process is both technological and biological - requiring coordination between scientific staff (microbiologists, agronomists), technical operators (field engineers), and management planners.

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This ecosystem-inspired hierarchy mirrors natural systems, where higher organisms (Executives) coordinate ecosystem balance, and each component species (employees) plays a defined ecological function.

5.2 Job Description Framework

The Job Description (JD) is a standardized HR instrument used to define, communicate, and evaluate employee duties.

Each JD includes:

- Title and Department
- Reports To
- Main Duties
- Key Performance Indicators (KPIs)
- Required Qualifications
- Contract Type
- Workplace (HQ, Regional, or Farm Site)

These elements ensure that all roles support both scientific rigor (for MR-CNA production quality) and economic viability (for export marketing).

5.3 Sample Job Descriptions

1. MR-CNA Production Engineer

Component Details

Reports To: Lead Technical Advisor

Department: MR-CNA Production & Quality Control

Main Duties: - Supervise daily MR-CNA composting and microbial formulation processes.
- Conduct lab-based nutrient balancing (NPKCS) and microbial count verification.
- Maintain fermentation tanks at optimal pH, temperature, and moisture conditions.
- Coordinate production reports with Agronomy and Marketing Units.
- Implement ECAE quality assurance protocols.

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Key Performance Indicators (KPIs): - Annual production of $\geq 38,000$ tons
100% MR-CNA adoption
Compost nutrient content within certified range (e.g., NPKCS 10:5:4:30:2).
- Zero non-conformity in lab audits.

Qualifications: BSc/MSc in Soil Science, Biochemical Engineering, or Microbiology.

Contract Type: Full-time, renewable based on annual review.

Workplace: Abobo Farm Site, Gambella.

Scientific Relevance:

The MR-CNA Engineer is the central node in the organic production system - responsible for maintaining microbial integrity, nutrient homogeneity, and ensuring that the biological “engine” of the farm runs efficiently.

This role’s effectiveness directly affects carbon sequestration, soil structure, and crop yield.

2. Senior Agronomist

| Reports To: | Regional Project Manager | | Department: | Land-Husbandry & Agronomy | | Main Duties: | - Implement field crop management strategies.
- Monitor plant response to MR-CNA soil application.
- Supervise CCGs in compost spreading, irrigation, and pest management.
- Collaborate with Research Center for experimental trials.
| | KPIs: | - $\geq 15\%$ yield increase per hectare per year.
- $\geq 90\%$ survival rate for planted seedlings.
- Successful adoption of MR-CNA by all CCGs under supervision. | | Qualifications: | BSc/MSc in Agronomy, Plant Science, or Agricultural Engineering. | | Contract Type: | Permanent. | | Workplace: | Abobo Farm Site & Gambella Regional Office. |

Scientific Note:

The agronomist bridges soil biology and plant physiology, ensuring that the chemical kinetics of MR-CNA decomposition match plant nutrient uptake

rates - a principle of bio-synchronization that underpins organic productivity.

3. Marketing & Export Officer

| Reports To: | Head of Marketing and Value Addition | | Main Duties: | - Identify export markets for organic produce and MR-CNA byproducts.
- Coordinate with Ethiopian Coffee and Tea Authority for export permits.
- Develop value chain analysis for spices, fruits, and timber products.
- Maintain relationships with logistics companies and exporters. | | KPIs: | - Yearly export growth $\geq 10\%$.
- Minimum three new international buyers per year.
- Compliance with organic certification (EU/USDA standards). | | Qualifications: | BA/BSc in Marketing, Economics, or Agribusiness. | | Workplace: | Addis Ababa HQ. |

Economic Relevance:

This position converts scientific innovation (MR-CNA-enhanced produce) into economic value. It embodies the “market diffusion” stage of Greenfield’s innovation lifecycle - ensuring project sustainability through international competitiveness.

4. Research and Training Officer

| Reports To: | Head of Research & Training Center | | Main Duties: | - Conduct applied research on MR-CNA microbial ecology and organic agronomy.
- Organize in-service training for CCG members and staff.
- Liaise with universities for collaborative projects.
- Document and publish project findings. | | KPIs: | - ≥ 4 training sessions per quarter.
- At least two published research reports per year.
- 80% trainee satisfaction rating. | | Qualifications: | MSc in Microbiology, Environmental Science, or Agricultural Extension. |

Scientific Integration:

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This position links knowledge production with field practice, translating 100% experimental data into operational improvements. It aligns with FAO's 2022 "Learning While Producing" model, promoting knowledge as a renewable input.

5. Field Technician (CCG Leader)

| Reports To: | Field Coordinator | | Main Duties: | - Lead CCG members in MR-CNA collection, fermentation, and field application.
- Monitor compost curing temperature and moisture.
- Record daily production data.
- Maintain safety standards and protective equipment usage. | | KPIs: | - MR-CNA production ≥ 3 tons/day.
- Zero safety incidents.
- Accurate data submission ($\geq 95\%$ compliance). | | Qualifications: | TVET Diploma or Certificate in Agriculture or Environmental Technology. |

Social Significance:

CCG leaders embody the "community entrepreneurship" vision of Greenfield - transforming unemployed youth into active participants in sustainable agriculture.

5.4 Job Evaluation and Pay Alignment

Each position's grade corresponds to job value determined by:

- Skill complexity,
- Decision-making responsibility,
- Impact on production and revenue, and
- Working environment (field vs. HQ).

HR uses a point-factor method (ILO, 2020) to determine pay scales, ensuring fairness, donor compliance, and internal equity.

5.5 Integration with HRIS

Each JD is digitized in the Human Resource Information System (HRIS) to enable:

- Performance tracking,
- Succession planning, and



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Payroll synchronization.

This ensures that job descriptions evolve dynamically with technology and project phases - a living document within Greenfield's HR ecosystem.

Scientific and Management Interpretation

From a systems theory perspective, Chapter V represents the "functional anatomy" of Greenfield Trading PLC's human ecosystem.

Just as MR-CNA improves the nutrient balance in soil, job classification ensures role equilibrium - preventing overlap, redundancy, and inefficiency.

Scientific Equilibrium: MR-CNA engineers and agronomists maintain biophysical balance in the soil.

Organizational Equilibrium: HR classifications maintain structural and human balance in the organization.

This dual balance sustains both biological productivity and institutional sustainability, reflecting a bio-inspired management philosophy.

PART VI: TRAINING AND CAPACITY DEVELOPMENT

6.1 Training Philosophy: “Learning While Producing”

The training and capacity development framework of Greenfield Trading PLC’s Organic Production and Marketing (OPM) Project is founded on the philosophy of “Learning While Producing.”

This concept recognizes that agricultural transformation is achieved not only through technology (like MR-CNA) but also through human knowledge cultivation - the soil of the mind.

The principle rests on three interdependent dimensions:

1. Knowledge Creation (Science):

Training is linked to real-time MR-CNA research, soil microbiology, and organic agronomy.

Staff are not passive recipients but active co-researchers generating new data for organic fertilizer efficiency, crop yield, and soil regeneration.

2. Skill Application (Practice):

Every training activity is embedded in day-to-day production. For instance, a workshop on MR-CNA fermentation kinetics is conducted beside the actual compost reactor, integrating theory with practice.

3. Value Internalization (Ethics):



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Capacity Building fosters ecological ethics, discipline, and innovation

The goal is to cultivate staff who treat the soil as a living organism - an ethical responsibility, not just an economic input.

This aligns with FAO's "Participatory Learning and Action Research (PLAR)" and UNDP's Human Development for Green Enterprises (2023) frameworks, emphasizing that human development is the foundation of environmental sustainability.

6.2 Types of Training

The OPM project establishes a multi-tiered training system designed to address different skill levels - from executives to field workers - ensuring that every employee contributes effectively to the organic value chain.

6.3 Training Infrastructure

Training is implemented through the Research & Training Center (R&T Center) located within the Abobo Farm Site.

The Center operates as a biological and educational hub, equipped with:

- Composting demonstration plots
- Microbial culture laboratory
- Training classrooms and video modules

On-site living laboratories where MR-CNA trials and experiments are conducted

It collaborates with:

Gambella University,

Addis Ababa Science and Technology University, and

Ethiopian Agricultural Research Institute (EIAR)

for joint curricula and internships.



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This institutional linkage ensures academic rigor, technology transfer, and 100% future recruitment pipelines.

6.4 Capacity Development Framework

Training is structured under a four-phase developmental model designed by the HR and R&T departments:

Each phase is monitored and evaluated through the Performance Management System (Chapter VII), creating a feedback loop between training and productivity.

6.5 Training Evaluation and Certification

To ensure quality and accountability, all training programs follow a four-level evaluation model (adapted from Kirkpatrick's Framework, 2016):

1. Reaction: Participant satisfaction surveys (immediate feedback).
2. Learning: Pre- and post-training tests to measure knowledge acquisition.
3. Behavior: Observation of workplace performance improvements.
4. Results: Quantifiable impact (e.g., yield increase, reduced waste, improved MR-CNA quality).

After each module, trainees receive a Certificate of Competence, registered in the HRIS. Certificates are recognized for:

- Promotion eligibility,
- Contract renewal, and
- CCG membership validation.

6.6 Knowledge Transfer and Localization

A key training objective is to decentralize expertise from expatriate advisors and senior consultants to local Ethiopian professionals and youth.

Mechanisms include:

Train-the-Trainer (ToT) programs for department heads.

Knowledge repositories (digital manuals, SOPs, video tutorials).

Mentorship programs pairing senior scientists with CCG leaders.

This ensures that when external experts complete their terms, local staff retain the institutional memory and operational capacity to sustain the OPM project autonomously.

6.7 Gender and Inclusion in Training

Aligned with the project's gender policy (Chapter III), the training unit ensures:

Minimum 40% female participation in technical courses;

Gender-sensitive content addressing workplace equality and safety;

Tailored programs for women entrepreneurs in CCG cooperatives (bookkeeping, marketing, compost management).

This reinforces Greenfield's commitment to empowering women through green innovation, a cornerstone of Ethiopia's national strategy for rural transformation.

Scientific and Management Interpretation

Training in the OPM Project is conceptualized as a biological feedback system, analogous to nutrient recycling in ecosystems:

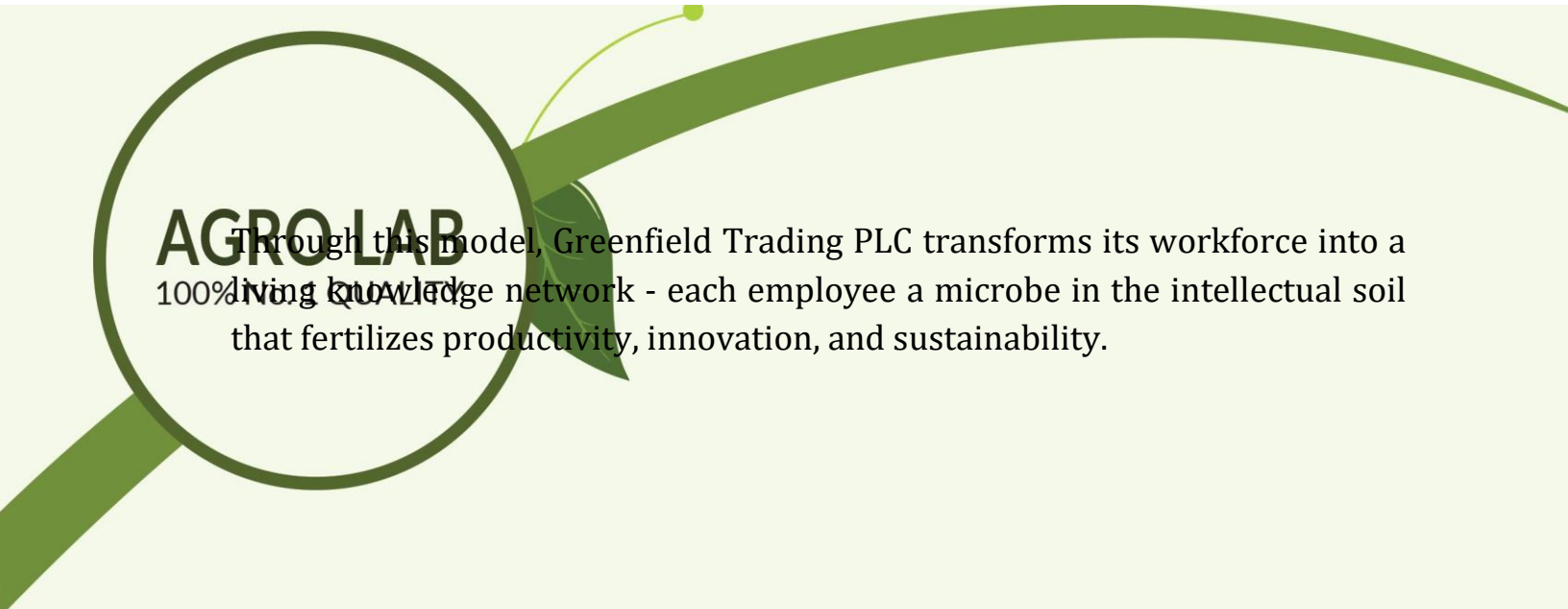
Input: Knowledge and technical resources (trainers, curriculum).

Transformation: Skill and behavior development through applied practice.

Output: Productive, innovative, and environmentally conscious workforce.

Feedback: Continuous monitoring and adaptive curriculum improvement.

This bio-inspired learning cycle aligns with "cognitive ecology" theory, suggesting that organizations evolve as adaptive learning organisms (UNDP, 2023).



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Through this model, Greenfield Trading PLC transforms its workforce into a 100% living knowledge network - each employee a microbe in the intellectual soil that fertilizes productivity, innovation, and sustainability.

PART VII: PERFORMANCE MANAGEMENT

7.1 Overview and Rationale

The Performance Management System (PMS) at Greenfield Trading PLC's Organic Production and Marketing (OPM) Project is designed as a strategic management tool linking human behavior, organizational goals, and biological productivity.

It functions as both a measurement framework and a development process, ensuring that:

Every staff member contributes to the project's scientific and socio-economic mission,

MR-CNA production and agronomic performance targets are achieved, and

High-performing individuals and teams are recognized, rewarded, and developed.

This approach transforms performance appraisal from a bureaucratic evaluation into a living feedback mechanism, aligning with the project's "learning while producing" philosophy (Chapter VI).

7.2 Performance Appraisal System

Appraisal Frequency and Structure

Performance appraisal is conducted biannually (every 6 months) and involves three sequential stages:

1. Self-Assessment

Each employee completes a structured self-evaluation form linked to their Job Description (Chapter V).

This encourages self-awareness and accountability.

2. Supervisor Evaluation

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Department Heads or immediate supervisors assess employee performance based on Key Performance Indicators (KPIs) and observed behavior. Supervisors provide qualitative feedback, noting strengths, areas for improvement, and training needs.

3. HR Consolidation and Review

The HR Department aggregates scores, normalizes data, and submits summary reports to the Project Director and HR Committee. This process ensures fairness and consistency across all departments.

Appraisal Criteria

Appraisals are conducted using a 100-point matrix, divided into four main dimensions:

Scores are then interpreted as:

- 90-100: Exceptional performance (eligible for reward)
- 75-89: Meets expectations (retain and encourage)
- 60-74: Needs improvement (training required)
- Below 60: Unsatisfactory (subject to remedial measures or disciplinary action)

7.3 Key Indicators by Department

Each department has tailored KPIs (Key Performance Indicators) that translate corporate goals into measurable performance outputs:

These departmental KPIs are scientifically grounded in the project's MR-CNA system, connecting human actions directly to ecological and economic outcomes.

7.4 Feedback and Coaching

Performance management is designed as a continuous coaching process, not a once-a-year evaluation. Supervisors are expected to:

Conduct monthly feedback meetings with their teams,

Document progress in a Performance Improvement Log (PIL),



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Collaborate with the HR Department to identify training or reassignment needs.

Encourage staff to propose innovations, even small-scale improvements in MR-CNA or irrigation systems.

Feedback is constructive, developmental, and participatory, following the FAO “Agro-Coaching” Model (2020) that promotes real-time mentoring in agricultural enterprises.

7.5 Reward and Recognition

Individual Awards:

Outstanding Performer of the Year: Certificate and 15% salary bonus.

Innovation Award: Given for research or production innovations leading to cost reduction or productivity increase.

Environmental Stewardship Award: For staff demonstrating exceptional adherence to ecological and safety standards.

Team Awards: Best Department of the Year (based on cumulative KPI results). Recognition for community engagement or social responsibility.

Promotion and Career Growth:

Employees who consistently score above 85% over two consecutive appraisal cycles are shortlisted for promotion, subject to available positions and competency tests (linked to HRIS data).

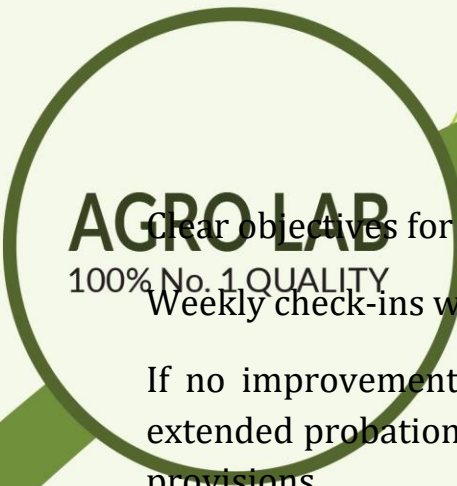
Reward Funding:

Awards and incentives are budgeted under the Annual HR Development Plan, ensuring sustainability and transparency.

7.6 Performance Improvement Plans (PIPs)

Employees scoring below 60% enter a Performance Improvement Plan (PIP) for a three-month period, during which they receive:

Tailored mentorship and training,



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Clear objectives for improvement,
Weekly check-ins with supervisors.

If no improvement occurs, the HR Department may recommend transfer, extended probation, or contract termination, following Ethiopian labour law provisions.

7.7 Integration with HRIS and Decision-Making

All appraisal data are recorded in the Human Resource Information System (HRIS), allowing:

Longitudinal tracking of performance trends,

Identification of high-potential staff for promotion,

Data-driven planning for training and recruitment.

Performance data also inform:

Annual Budgeting: Aligning incentives with productivity.

Donor Reporting: Providing human capital metrics in project evaluations.

Strategic Reviews: Adjusting operational methods based on staff efficiency.

This digital integration aligns with Ethiopia's Public Service Reform Program (2022) encouraging data-driven HR governance.

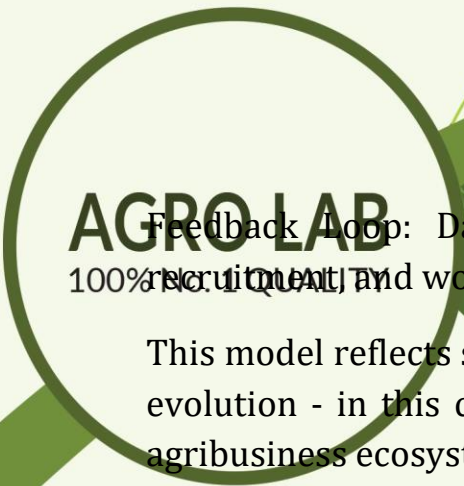
Scientific and Management Interpretation

From a scientific standpoint, the performance management system mirrors biological homeostasis the process by which living systems maintain equilibrium.

Inputs: Skills, motivation, and organizational support.

Process: Continuous evaluation, adaptation, and feedback.

Outputs: High-quality MR-CNA soil, improved yield, and market expansion.



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Feedback Loop: Data from performance appraisals informs training, recruitment, and workflow design.

This model reflects system ecology theory, where feedback ensures adaptive evolution - in this case, the evolution of human capability in a sustainable agribusiness ecosystem.

By linking human energy and ecological regeneration, Greenfield's PMS establishes a bio-economic synchronization, proving that sustainable productivity arises not from machines alone, but from well-trained, motivated people aligned with nature's rhythms.

CHAPTER VIII - COMPENSATION AND BENEFITS

8.1 Salary Policy

The compensation structure at Greenfield Trading PLC's Organic Production and Marketing (OPM) Project is designed to ensure fairness, competitiveness, and motivation, while maintaining financial sustainability within donor-funded and private investment frameworks.

The salary system is benchmarked against Ethiopian agribusiness, environmental, and development projects (e.g., ATA, EIAR, and World Bank-funded programs). It follows a hybrid model combining position-based and competency-based pay systems.

Principles of the Salary Policy:

1. **Equity and Fairness:** Equal pay for equal work, irrespective of gender, ethnicity, or regional origin.
2. **Market Competitiveness:** Salary levels are adjusted to reflect prevailing rates in comparable national and international agricultural projects.
3. **Transparency and Consistency:** Pay scales and increments are approved by the HR Committee and made accessible to all employees through HR circulars.
4. **Performance Linkage:** Annual salary increments (5-10%) are based on performance appraisal results (Chapter VII). High-performing staff (scores above 85%) may receive merit-based bonuses.



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5. Periodical Review: The salary scale is reviewed every two years to reflect inflation and changes in the national minimum wage policy.

Salary Scale Framework

Note: Salary adjustments are reviewed biannually by the HR Committee in consultation with the Finance Department and donors. All payments comply with Ethiopian tax regulations and pension laws.

8.2 Allowances

Allowances supplement base pay to recognize workplace hardship, risk exposure, and mobility requirements, especially given the remote location of the OPM project in Abobo, Gambella.

Key Allowance Categories

1. Field Duty Allowance

Provided to staff assigned to farm operations, CCG supervision, or on-site MR-CNA production.

Calculated at 15-25% of base salary depending on exposure level and work hours.

2. Hardship Allowance

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For staff stationed in remote or high-temperature zones (Abobo and 100% Gambella sites). Fixed rate of ETB 3,000-5,000/month as compensation for geographical hardship.

3. Health and Housing Support

Staff posted to the field receive housing assistance (on-site accommodation or rent subsidy).

Medical check-ups are provided quarterly; family health support is covered under insurance (Section 8.3).

4. Transport and Communication Allowance

Field staff and CCG coordinators receive transport stipends or company vehicle support. Communication allowance (ETB 1,000-1,500/month) ensures reliable connectivity for remote supervision.

5. Meal and Subsistence Allowance

For employees working overtime or at field locations without access to dining facilities. These allowances are not merely financial compensation but productivity enhancers - enabling staff to maintain health, focus, and performance in challenging rural conditions.

8.3 Insurance and Safety

Given the physical and biological risks involved in MR-CNA soil production and farm operations, Greenfield Trading PLC maintains comprehensive insurance and safety coverage for all employees.

Insurance Coverage:

Type Coverage Details

Life Insurance Pays benefits to dependents in the event of death during employment. Accident Insurance Covers occupational injuries, including

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fieldwork accidents. Medical Insurance Reimburses outpatient and inpatient medical costs for staff and immediate family.

Pension and Social Security Contributions made to the Ethiopian Private Organization Employees Pension Fund.

Safety Measures: Provision of Personal Protective Equipment (PPE) - gloves, masks, boots, and helmets for all field workers. Regular safety training on compost handling, biological hazard prevention, and chemical exposure control.

Establishment of a Safety Committee responsible for incident investigation, risk assessment, and hazard reporting. Compliance with ISO 45001 Occupational Health and Safety Management Standards.

Scientific Justification: The MR-CNA production process involves microbial fermentation, ammonia release, and heat generation - all requiring controlled safety protocols. Protective measures prevent contamination, heat stress, and respiratory irritation, ensuring workforce wellbeing and process quality.

8.4 Non-Monetary Benefits

In addition to financial compensation, Greenfield Trading PLC provides a comprehensive package of non-monetary benefits to support staff morale, retention, and social well-being.

1. Leave and Time-Off Benefits

Annual Leave: 20 working days per year after 12 months of service.

Sick Leave: 6 months (50% paid) as per Ethiopian Labour Proclamation.

Maternity/Paternity Leave: 120 days maternity, 5 days paternity.

Compassionate Leave: Up to 5 days for family emergencies.

2. Training and Education Incentives



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Access to external scholarships, donor-sponsored workshops, and short-term international training (Chapter VI). Tuition reimbursement for degree-related studies aligned with company objectives.

3. Recreational and Cultural Programs

Annual staff retreat for team building. Community events linking staff with local Gambella residents (e.g., tree planting, environmental days).

4. Performance-Based Recognition

Certificates, awards, and public commendations (linked to Chapter VII).

8.5 Economic Rationale for Compensation Design

Compensation under the OPM Project is not solely administrative - it's a productivity strategy embedded in economic and behavioral science.

A. Motivation and Productivity Link

Higher and fair wages stimulate intrinsic motivation, reduce absenteeism, and improve retention. Research by the ILO (2020) confirms that fair pay in agricultural enterprises directly correlates with output quality, innovation, and social cohesion.

B. Cost-Benefit Balance

While high pay increases short-term cost, it reduces turnover and training costs. Each trained MR-CNA technician costs an estimated ETB 45,000 to replace - thus, maintaining competitive compensation is economically rational.

C. Incentive Alignment

The inclusion of performance-linked bonuses ensures that compensation reflects both individual productivity and organizational results. This structure harmonizes personal ambition with collective mission - a central principle of organizational ecology.

The HR and Finance Departments jointly review all compensation components every two years. Adjustments are based on: Market salary surveys (Ethiopian HR Association data), Inflation rates published by the National Bank of Ethiopia, Donor audit recommendations, and Employee feedback surveys.

Final recommendations are approved by the HR Committee and endorsed by the Project Steering Committee (PSC).

Scientific and Management Interpretation

The compensation system is viewed through the lens of bioeconomic balance - a principle stating that sustainable ecosystems (and organizations) maintain equilibrium between input (effort) and reward (resources).

Biological Analogy: In an ecosystem, nutrients flow proportionally to need and function. Similarly, Greenfield's pay system distributes income based on contribution, skill, and environmental hardship.

Human Systems Insight: Fair compensation fosters psychological homeostasis - satisfaction, belonging, and productivity - essential to sustainable project growth.

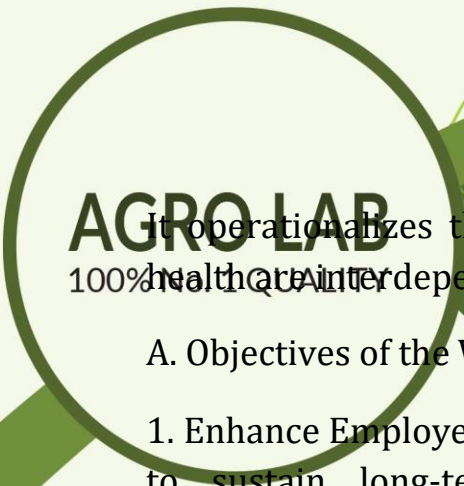
Strategic Alignment: By linking pay with performance, safety, and training, Greenfield creates a self-regulating human system that mirrors nature's own adaptive cycles.

Thus, Chapter VIII reinforces the philosophy that "human well-being is the foundation of ecological sustainability."

PART IX: STAFF WELFARE AND DISCIPLINE

9.1 Staff Welfare Program

The Staff Welfare Program at Greenfield Trading PLC - OPM Project is designed to ensure the physical, mental, social, and spiritual well-being of employees, recognizing that a healthy and motivated workforce is the foundation of sustainable productivity.



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It operationalizes the project's guiding principle: "Human health and soil health are interdependent ecosystems."

A. Objectives of the Welfare Program

1. Enhance Employee Well-being - Support physical and psychological health to sustain long-term productivity in remote and demanding field environments.
2. Promote Work-Life Balance - Provide rest, recreation, and family support systems for employees and dependents.
3. Encourage Social Inclusion - Strengthen unity among diverse employees from different regions, ethnicities, and professional backgrounds.
4. Embed Ecological Ethics - Reinforce values of care, cooperation, and environmental responsibility within the workforce culture.

B. Core Welfare Services

These welfare provisions not only improve morale but also strengthen the ecological citizenship of employees - aligning human welfare with environmental stewardship.

C. Social and Community Engagement

The welfare policy promotes corporate-community partnership through: Local employment (CCGs), Community infrastructure projects (e.g., water points, schools, and clinics), and Environmental education campaigns.

This approach ensures that staff welfare extends beyond the organization to the local Gambella communities, reinforcing social trust and shared prosperity.

9.2 Disciplinary Procedures

Greenfield Trading PLC emphasizes a preventive and corrective approach to discipline, focusing on education and rehabilitation rather than punishment. The goal is to uphold professionalism, ethics, and harmony while

A. Disciplinary Principles

1. Fairness and Due Process: No disciplinary action is taken without thorough investigation and opportunity for defense.
2. Proportionality: The severity of penalties matches the gravity of the misconduct.
3. Confidentiality: All cases are handled with discretion to protect employee dignity.
4. Restorative Justice: Aim to correct behavior and reintegrate employees into the organizational community.

B. Disciplinary Code

Each case follows a structured investigation and approval process.

C. Disciplinary Process

1. Incident Reporting: Complaint or observation submitted to HR or supervisor.
2. Preliminary Investigation: HR reviews facts and evidence.
3. Hearing: Employee is invited to defend themselves in front of a small committee (HR + Department + Legal Advisor).
4. Decision: Committee recommends action to the Project Director.
5. Record and Follow-up: HR documents case details and outcomes in the HRIS Disciplinary Log.
6. Appeal: Employees may appeal to the Project Steering Committee (PSC) within 10 working days.

This process ensures legal compliance and prevents arbitrary disciplinary actions.



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9.3 Grievance Redress Mechanism

Greenfield Trading PLC maintains a multi-channel grievance system that ensures employees' voices are heard, promoting transparency, trust, and early conflict resolution.

Grievance Channels:

1. Confidential Suggestion/Grievance Boxes at each work site.
2. Direct Submission to HR Department (in writing or verbally).
3. CCG Liaison Officers for community-based staff concerns.
4. Email Hotline (for remote workers and administrative staff).

Grievance Handling Procedure:

1. Submission: Complaint filed to HR within 5 working days of incident.
2. Acknowledgment: HR issues a receipt of complaint within 2 days.
3. Investigation: Conducted by HR and a neutral member of the Welfare Committee.
4. Resolution: Case decided within 10 working days.
5. Appeal: Escalation to Project Director or PSC if unresolved.

The process is documented and integrated into the HRIS system, ensuring traceability and accountability.

9.4 Psychological and Ethical Framework

A. Psychological Well-Being

Greenfield recognizes that emotional stability and social belonging directly influence performance, retention, and creativity.

Hence, welfare policies incorporate:

Access to confidential counseling,

Stress management workshops,



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Regular recreational breaks and retreats,

Flexible leave for personal or family emergencies.

These measures align with ILO's Psychological Health at Work Guidelines (2020) and WHO's Mental Health in the Workplace Model (2021).

B. Ethical Conduct and Organizational Values

Every employee is expected to uphold the organization's Code of Conduct and Ethics, emphasizing:

Integrity, Respect, Accountability, and Ecological responsibility.

This ethical framework forms the moral backbone of Greenfield's environmental enterprise, linking human ethics to land ethics (Leopold, 1949).

9.5 Integration with HRIS and Performance Systems

All welfare and disciplinary records are digitally stored in the Human Resource Information System (HRIS) to ensure:

Transparency in disciplinary cases,

Monitoring of grievance resolution timelines,

Integration of welfare data into annual HR audits, and

Early identification of psychosocial risks or departmental issues.

This digital integration supports evidence-based management and donor compliance in HR monitoring and evaluation.

Scientific and Management Interpretation

From a systems-science perspective, the Welfare and Discipline framework operates as an organizational immune system - detecting, correcting, and healing dysfunctions to maintain health and equilibrium.

Welfare: Acts as the nutrition that nourishes morale and engagement.



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Discipline: Acts as the immune response that prevents ethical decay.

Grievance systems: Function as nerve signals, identifying stress points and restoring balance.

Together, these mechanisms sustain organizational homeostasis - a balanced state in which productivity, morale, and ethical behavior coexist harmoniously.

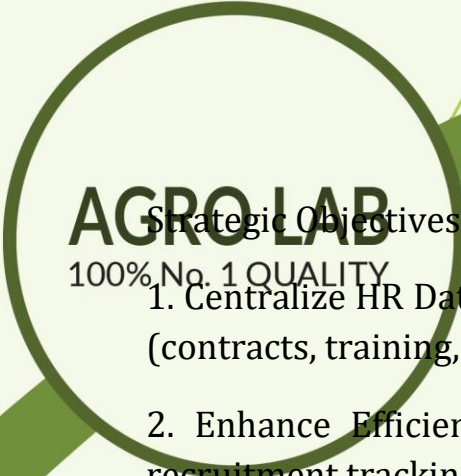
This ecological analogy reflects Greenfield's human-centered philosophy: "An organization must heal and protect its people just as soil protects life."

PART X: HUMAN RESOURCE INFORMATION SYSTEM (HRIS)

10.1 Purpose and Strategic Vision

The Human Resource Information System (HRIS) of Greenfield Trading PLC - OPM Project serves as the digital nervous system of the organization - collecting, processing, and analyzing employee-related data to support evidence-based decision-making, operational efficiency, and organizational transparency.

The HRIS transforms HR from an administrative function into a data-driven management discipline, aligning human resource planning, payroll, performance, and capacity building into one integrated digital ecosystem.



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Strategic Objectives:

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1. Centralize HR Data: Create a single source of truth for all staff information (contracts, training, attendance, performance).
2. Enhance Efficiency: Automate repetitive HR functions (leave, payroll, recruitment tracking).
3. Strengthen Compliance: Ensure adherence to Ethiopian labour laws, donor audit requirements, and ISO management standards.
4. Improve Transparency: Reduce paperwork, human error, and bias by digitizing approvals and monitoring systems.
5. Enable Data-Driven Decision-Making: Use analytics to forecast manpower needs, evaluate productivity trends, and identify training gaps.

10.2 System Architecture and Components

The HRIS is designed as a modular platform that integrates five interdependent subsystems, forming a complete digital human capital management environment.

All modules communicate through a central HR data server hosted at the Addis Ababa HQ, with secure remote access for the Gambella Regional Office and Abobo Farm Site.

10.3 Data Management and Workflow Automation

A. Data Flow Structure

1. Input Stage: HR officers enter or import employee data during recruitment and onboarding.
2. Processing Stage: The system automatically calculates leave balances, payroll adjustments, and performance scores using predefined algorithms.
3. Output Stage: HRIS generates monthly reports for the Project Director, HR Committee, and donors (as part of the M&E framework). This automation reduces manual data entry time by over 60% and ensures data accuracy above 95%, consistent with ISO 9001 quality management benchmarks.

E-signature approvals for HR requests (leave, recruitment, and training). Automated reminders for contract renewals, probation reviews, and appraisal deadlines. Data dashboards displaying KPIs by department. Linkage with Finance System for synchronized payroll updates. Report Generation: Monthly HR Analytics Reports summarizing staff statistics, gender balance, and training progress.

Scientific Parallel:

The HRIS functions like a central nervous system-collecting signals (data), processing them (analysis), and coordinating responses (management decisions). Just as MR-CNA balances nutrients in soil ecosystems, HRIS balances human resource information across departments.

10.4 Reporting Line and Responsibility

The HRIS follows a clear hierarchical reporting structure ensuring accountability and security:

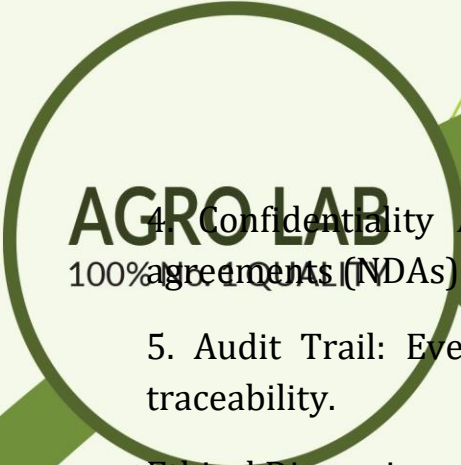
At the operational level, HRIS administrators coordinate directly with the IT Department to manage servers, user access, and backup systems.

10.5 Data Security and Confidentiality

Greenfield Trading PLC maintains strict data protection and privacy protocols in line with Ethiopian ICT laws and international data ethics principles (ISO 27001).

Security Mechanisms:

1. Access Control: Role-based user permissions restrict access to sensitive data (only HR and authorized managers).
2. Data Encryption: All HRIS data are encrypted using 256-bit AES encryption to prevent breaches.
3. Backups: Daily automatic backups are stored on secure cloud servers and local drives.



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4. Confidentiality Agreements: All HR and IT staff sign nondisclosure agreements (NDAs).

5. Audit Trail: Every edit or data entry is timestamped and logged for traceability.

Ethical Dimension:

Data confidentiality is treated as an extension of human dignity - protecting personal identity as an ethical responsibility, not just a technical task.

This reflects Greenfield's value of "Respect for People as Living Data."

10.6 Integration with Other Systems

The HRIS is interoperable with: Finance and Procurement Systems (for salary and resource allocation),

Monitoring & Evaluation (M&E) Database (for performance and productivity reporting), Training Management System (TMS) (for course registration and feedback analysis), and Donor Reporting Platforms (for quarterly workforce analytics). This digital ecosystem ensures a seamless flow of information between human capital management and organizational performance metrics.

10.7 HR Analytics and Decision Support

The HRIS provides real-time analytics dashboards that allow management to visualize:

Staff turnover trends, Gender balance ratios, Training return-on-investment (ROI), Performance vs. compensation correlation, MR-CNA production efficiency linked to staff metrics.

These data insights support predictive workforce planning, enabling the HR Committee to anticipate manpower needs as project activities expand through 2033.

10.8 System Maintenance and Review



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The HRIS is reviewed every two years or upon donor request to ensure 100% functionality, security, and alignment with updated HR policies.

Maintenance Activities:

Quarterly system audit by the IT Unit.

Annual data integrity verification.

Biannual staff training in HRIS use and data ethics.

Continuous upgrades to adapt to organizational and technological changes.

Scientific and Management Interpretation

From a systems theory perspective, the HRIS embodies the digital metabolism of Greenfield's organizational body - continuously processing human data into management energy.

Information $\approx$ Nutrients: Just as MR-CNA delivers balanced nutrients to plants, the HRIS delivers balanced information to decision-makers.

Automation $\approx$ Efficiency: Like enzymes in soil chemistry, automation accelerates reactions (workflows) without loss of control.

Security $\approx$ Homeostasis: Data protection maintains the equilibrium of trust and operational stability.

This integration of bio-logic and techno-logic represents Greenfield's pioneering approach to "Ecological Informatics in Human Resource Management."



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PART XI: MONITORING AND REVIEW

11.1 Purpose and Rationale

The Monitoring and Review (M&R) system ensures that Greenfield Trading PLC's HR policies remain effective, equitable, and aligned with the evolving needs of the Organic Production and Marketing (OPM) Project. It acts as the feedback mechanism of the HR ecosystem - observing performance, identifying strengths and gaps, and generating insights for continuous organizational improvement.

The HR monitoring framework is designed around three strategic goals:

1. **Accountability:** Demonstrate transparent and lawful management of human resources to both employees and donors.

2. Learning: Transform HR data and experiences into actionable 100% organizational knowledge.

3. Adaptation: Adjust HR strategies and policies to remain relevant to project growth and environmental changes.

11.2 Monitoring Framework

Monitoring is conducted as a continuous process that systematically tracks the implementation and impact of HR policies across departments and field operations.

Core Monitoring Dimensions

Monitoring data are compiled monthly and reviewed in quarterly HR performance meetings chaired by the Project Director.

11.3 HR Review Process

The review process converts monitoring data into strategic insights for decision-making. It is conducted on three levels:

1. Operational Review (Quarterly)

Departmental HR reports are reviewed by the HR Committee.

Focus: short-term performance, compliance, and workflow issues.

2. Management Review (Biannual)

The HR Director and Project Director analyze cumulative data.

Focus: policy adherence, staff development, productivity correlation.

3. Strategic Review (Annual)

Conducted by the Project Steering Committee (PSC) with participation of donors and external auditors.

Focus: alignment of HR systems with the OPM Project's mission, donor standards, and national HR regulations.

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Each review concludes with an HR Improvement Action Plan (HRIAP) specifying actions, responsibilities, and deadlines.

11.4 Feedback and Learning Mechanisms

Greenfield's M&R system treats feedback as an organizational nutrient-a vital input for adaptive growth and innovation.

Key Feedback Channels:

1. Employee Surveys: Annual anonymous questionnaires assessing satisfaction, motivation, and workplace culture.
2. Exit Interviews: Collect data from departing employees to identify systemic weaknesses.
3. Post-Training Evaluations: Measure learning outcomes and field application rates.
4. Suggestion Systems: Digital HRIS modules allowing employees to submit ideas or complaints confidentially.
5. Donor Feedback: Annual monitoring visits by funding agencies evaluating HR compliance and impact.

Feedback Integration:

Insights from all sources are synthesized in quarterly HR Analytics Reports and used to revise HR strategies, training curricula, and welfare initiatives.

11.5 HR Audit and Compliance

A. Internal HR Audit

Conducted annually by Greenfield's HR Audit Team in collaboration with Finance and M&E departments.

Verifies consistency between policy and practice in recruitment, payroll, welfare, and training. Uses ISO 9001 and ILO "Decent Work Indicators" as audit benchmarks.

B. External HR Audit

Performed by independent auditors or donor representatives every two years. Evaluates compliance with Ethiopian labour law, donor regulations, and ethical standards. Results are shared with the Project Steering Committee and summarized in the Annual Organizational Review Report (AORR).

C. Corrective and Preventive Action (CAPA) Non-conformities identified during audits are addressed through formal CAPA procedures:

1. Root-cause analysis,
2. Corrective measures (policy or operational change),
3. Verification of effectiveness within 3 months.

This ensures continual policy refinement and institutional resilience.

11.6 Key Performance Indicators (KPIs) for HR Monitoring

These KPIs establish measurable standards for HR effectiveness and ensure the system remains results-oriented and evidence-based.

11.7 Reporting and Documentation

All HR monitoring and review reports follow a structured reporting cycle:

1. Monthly HR Report: Department-level operational summaries.
2. Quarterly HR Review Report: Comprehensive analysis of progress toward KPIs.
3. Annual HR Development Report (AHRDR): Includes training outcomes, audit results, and strategic HR recommendations.
4. Donor Compliance Report: Prepared jointly with the Finance and M&E Units, ensuring transparency and accountability to funding partners.

All reports are archived digitally in the HRIS repository, accessible to authorized management only.



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11.8 Organizational Learning and Adaptation

Greenfield's HR monitoring system goes beyond compliance - it acts as a learning engine.

Data and experiences are analyzed to identify patterns and predict future needs.

Learning Applications:

HR data used to update job descriptions (Chapter V).

Performance trends guide training design (Chapter VI).

Grievance patterns inform welfare improvements (Chapter IX).

Compensation analysis supports pay scale revision (Chapter VIII).

This feedback loop ensures HR remains dynamic, evolving alongside the biological, social, and market realities of the OPM Project.

Scientific and Management Interpretation

From a systems and biological perspective, monitoring and review mirror the feedback regulation mechanisms found in natural ecosystems:

Sensors (M&E Tools) detect performance deviations.

Control Centers (HR Committee, PSC) interpret the data.

Effectors (Departments, Supervisors) implement corrective actions.

Equilibrium (Sustainability) is achieved through continuous adjustment.

Just as the MR-CNA soil system self-regulates nutrient balance, the HRM system uses monitoring feedback to self-correct organizational health.

This process exemplifies organizational homeodynamics - the dynamic equilibrium of human, environmental, and institutional components.



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Greenfield's M&R system thus transforms HR from a static policy framework into a living ecosystem that learns, adapts, and regenerates - the essence of sustainable human resource governance.

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